

Veloria Grand Autopilot Brief

What the system is, what it already automates, what is silently switched off, and the full register of work we want moved to autopilot across the team, the client and management.

SYSTEM Veloria Grand ERP	LIVE AT app.theveloriagrand.com	STACK Next.js 16 · Prisma · Neon · Vercel
BRIEF DATE 7 September 2026	STATUS In production, single company	

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01 In one paragraph

Veloria Grand runs a wedding and events venue business end to end — from the Google ad that produces an enquiry, through quotation, booking and payment, into event operations, kitchen, vendors and logistics, and out the other side into accounting, payroll and property acquisition. It is a large system: **335 database tables and roughly 404,000 lines of code across 65 modules.**

The important thing for an automation specialist to understand on day one is this: **the automation layer is already largely built and is largely not running.** There are 50 scheduled jobs in the codebase — follow-up sequences, SLA escalations, payment reminders, pre-event reminder ladders, win-back campaigns, review requests. The hosting configuration registers **two schedules, both of which fire once a day.** And the two credentials needed to send an email or an SMS are **absent from the production environment**, so every automated message the system tries to send reaches nobody and reports no error.

So the first job is not building automation. It is **turning on the automation that exists** — which is mostly credentials and scheduling — and then building the register in section 07 onward on top of a foundation that actually fires.

02 Scale and shape

335 Database tables Prisma models, one Neon Postgres	404k Lines of TypeScript 279 server-action files	65 Modules Plus 4 external-facing portals
50 Scheduled jobs written 49 reachable, 1 orphaned	2 Schedules registered Both fire once daily	33 / 67 Env vars set in production Code reads 67

Those last two tiles are the whole story. The system was built to run itself; the environment it is deployed into does not let it.

03 What the system covers

Six business domains, one database, one login. It is a single-company ERP, not a multi-tenant SaaS — staff-wide visibility is deliberate, and most records are not owner-scoped by design.

Demand & Sales Ad and web enquiry capture, lead pipeline, scoring, quotations with a package catalogue, e-signed contracts, bookings and the availability calendar. leads · inquiries · pipeline · quotations · contracts · bookings · availability · calendar · campaigns · site-visits · referrals · loyalty	Event Operations Once a booking confirms, operations are provisioned from SOP templates: function sheets, kitchen plans, staffing, vendor assignment, procurement, logistics and day-of run sheets. beo · kitchen · menu · procurement · logistics · vendors · resources · inventory · rentals · quality · support
Money Double-entry general ledger with sub-ledgers, invoices and installments, Razorpay collection, vendor bills and payouts, bank reconciliation, commissions, budgets and assets. finance · invoices · payments · payouts · commissions · accounts · reports	People Full HR platform on shared identity: attendance, leave, shifts, payroll with Indian statutory calculation (PF, ESI, PT, TDS), reimbursements, appraisals, recruitment and onboarding. people · recruitment · performance · staff · me (self-service)
Growth & Property A separate BD pipeline for acquiring venues — hall owners, site visits, evaluations, capex projections, contracts — then a Projects module that readies the venue to brand standard. bd · projects · owners · franchise · competitors · marketing	Outside-facing surfaces Four separate portals outside the staff login: a public site (quote configurator, date holds, RSVP, referrals), a host portal for the couple, a guest app, and a vendor portal. /configure · /hold · /q · /rsvp · /refer · /visit · portal · vendor-portal · widget

04 How it is built — and the one thing that will surprise you

Next.js 16 App Router on Vercel, Prisma 6 against Neon Postgres, NextAuth for sessions, Tailwind v4 for styling. Twenty-three user roles across two parallel permission systems.

The surprise: business logic lives in *server actions* — roughly 279 files marked "use server", called directly from React components. It is not a REST API with a service layer behind it. There are about 100 HTTP route handlers, but they are webhooks, cron entry points, PDF renderers and public form endpoints, not a general-purpose API.

What that means in practice: **an external automation tool such as n8n, Zapier or Make has almost nothing to call today.** There is no GET /api/leads. Any plan that assumes "we will wire the CRM into a workflow tool" needs an API layer built first, or needs the automation to live inside the application.

There is a precedent to follow. The codebase already has an `ApiKey` table and a versioned, key-authenticated endpoint pair at `/api/v1/marketing/offline-conversions` (read plus acknowledge). That is the pattern to extend into a proper `/api/v1/*` surface rather than inventing a new one. Deciding *in-process versus external orchestrator* is the first architectural call the automation lead has to make, and it should be made in week one because everything else follows from it.

05 Automation machinery that already exists

Do not rebuild any of this. It is written, tested in places, and in most cases only needs to be switched on, configured, or scheduled properly. This inventory is the single most valuable page in this brief for whoever is hired.

PRIMITIVE	WHAT IT DOES	WHERE IT LIVES	STATE
Cron lanes	Three lanes (daily, frequent, fast) each running a declared list of jobs concurrently, with a heartbeat row and admin alerts on failure	<code>lib/cron/run-lane.ts</code>	• UNDER-SCHEDULED
Workflow engine	Trigger to actions, stored as JSON, with a run log. Six triggers wired: lead created, event created, booking confirmed, payment due, event tomorrow, post event	<code>lib/workflow-executor.ts</code>	• BUILT, FEW RULES
Cadence engine	Multi-step outreach sequences with auto-enrolment criteria, per-step delays and exit conditions when a prospect replies	<code>lib/cadence-executor.ts</code>	• RUNS ONCE DAILY
Assignment rules	Condition-matched lead routing, direct or round-robin across a team list, with rep availability and open-load awareness	<code>AssignmentRule</code> , <code>lib/routing</code>	• NO RULES CONFIGURED
Approval chains	Condition-triggered multi-step approvals on quotes, deals and bookings, with recorded decisions	<code>lib/approval-engine.ts</code>	• BUILT, UNCONFIGURED
Escalation engine	Tiered SLA breach escalation, including a war-room ladder for first-response failures	<code>lib/escalation-engine.ts</code> , <code>lib/sla</code>	• RUNS ONCE DAILY

PRIMITIVE	WHAT IT DOES	WHERE IT LIVES	STATE
Blueprint engine	Stage-transition rules — what must be true to advance, and what fires automatically when you do	<code>lib/blueprint-engine.ts</code>	● BUILT
Scoring rules	Configurable lead scoring rule sets plus a nightly decay pass on stale leads	<code>lib/scoring-engine.ts</code>	● FIRING
SOP provisioning	On booking confirmation, generates the full execution plan — phases, tasks, checklists — from SOP templates, with a nightly reconcile backstop for anything missed	<code>lib/ops</code>	● FIRING
Velos points engine	Config-driven gamification: idempotent point awards, quests, leaderboards, slump detection	<code>lib/velos</code>	● FIRING
Reminder rules	HR reminder rules with a per-day idempotency guard — birthdays, work anniversaries, document expiry, probation end	<code>HRReminderRule</code>	● EMAIL DEAD
Channel choke points	Every outbound message funnels through one function per channel — <code>sendEmail</code> , <code>sendWhatsApp</code> , <code>sendSMS</code> , <code>notify</code> . Swapping a provider is a one-file change	<code>lib/email.ts</code> , <code>lib/whatsapp</code> , <code>lib/sms.ts</code> , <code>lib/notify.ts</code>	● GOOD DESIGN
Health surface	An integration health page that reports, per integration, whether it is live and exactly which variables are missing; plus <code>/api/health</code> for cron heartbeats	<code>lib/integrations/health.ts</code>	● FIRING

Inbound integrations that are genuinely connected today: Razorpay (payment collection plus signed webhook), Runo cloud telephony, WhatsApp via Weflux or Meta, the Google Ads lead webhook and the offline-conversion upload API, plus public web forms and the embeddable enquiry widget. These are live in production and carrying real traffic.

06 Four things blocking autopilot today

These are stated plainly because an automation hire will otherwise spend their first month building on sand. None of the four is a redesign. Three are configuration.

B1 Nothing the system sends by email or SMS reaches anybody

• CRITICAL

Production has **33 environment variables**. The code reads **67**. Among the absent: `RESEND_API_KEY` and `EMAIL_FROM` for email, and `SMS_PROVIDER` with its `MSG91` or Twilio credentials for SMS.

Every integration in this codebase is written to *degrade gracefully* — a missing key produces a returned error object, not a thrown exception. So `sendEmail()` has been quietly returning "Email not configured" for the life of the deployment. No screen shows it. No log anyone reads records it. **This is why the symptom has always presented to the business as "the APIs keep failing" rather than "nothing is configured"**.

Practically: lead assignment notices, quotation sends, invoice emails, payment reminders, review requests, HR reminders and every cadence step that uses email or SMS have never been delivered. WhatsApp and in-app notifications do work, which is why the failure was never total enough to be obvious.

FIX

Add the credentials to the hosting environment and redeploy. No code changes. Roughly an hour of work, and it retroactively activates dozens of already-built automations. Verify on the integration health page at `/settings/integrations/health`, which lists exactly what is missing.

B2 Time-sensitive automation runs once a day

• CRITICAL

The codebase defines three cron lanes with deliberately different cadences. The hosting config registers **two schedules, both daily** — the batch lane at 02:00 UTC and the so-called "frequent" lane at 03:00 UTC, which is 08:30 in the morning, India time, once per day.

The frequent lane carries the work that is worthless when late: first-response SLA escalation, due cadence steps, viewed-but-unpaid quote nudges, support and BD SLA checks, rep availability, and the **48 / 24 / 12 / 4-hour pre-event reminder ladder**. A four-hour-before reminder evaluated once a day is not a four-hour reminder.

The fast lane — speed-to-lead, the thing that most directly converts ad spend — has **no schedule of its own at all**; it is reached only as one entry inside the daily-ish frequent lane.

FIX

Either move the project to a Vercel plan that permits sub-daily crons and set the real cadences (fast every 2–5 minutes, frequent hourly), or point a free external scheduler at the lane endpoints with the CRON_SECRET bearer token. The endpoints and auth already exist and need no change.

B3 There is no file storage

• STRUCTURAL

Documents, payslips, bill photographs and event images are stored as base64 strings inside Postgres, because no object storage was ever provisioned. That caps any single upload at roughly **4.5 MB**, the platform's request body limit, and it bloats the database.

Any automation touching documents — auto-attaching bills to vendor payments, emailing payslips, pushing event photos to the host portal, archiving signed contracts — runs into this ceiling immediately.

FIX

Provision object storage (S3, Cloudflare R2 or Vercel Blob) and migrate the upload paths behind the existing helpers. This is real engineering work, perhaps a week, and it should be scheduled before any document-heavy automation is attempted rather than discovered during it.

B4 No safety net on changes

● PROCESS

Deployments are CLI uploads from a developer's laptop, not triggered by the Git repository. TypeScript and lint validation are **switched off during the build**, so a type error ships. There is no continuous integration running the test suite before a deploy.

An automation engineer writing scheduled jobs that touch money, payroll and customer messaging needs to know that **nothing will catch a mistake before customers do**. There is a decent test suite in the repository; nothing runs it automatically.

FIX

Connect the repository to the host for build-on-push, add a CI job running the type checker, the tests and a frozen-lockfile install, then re-enable build-time validation. Half a day, and it is the precondition for letting a new engineer ship confidently.

B5 One orphaned job

● MINOR, BUT TELLING

Of 50 scheduled jobs, 49 are reachable from a lane. One is not: `sync-runo`, which pulls call logs from the telephony provider. Call records are one of the three sources that feed the per-lead engagement count, so while it is orphaned, **calls made by the sales team do not count as engagement** and leads look colder than they are.

FIX

One line — add it to the frequent lane's job list.

07 Client end — what the customer should experience without us touching it

● FIRING

Built and actually running in production today.

● INERT

Written and deployed, but cannot deliver — blocked by B1 or B2.

● BUILD

Does not exist. New work.

C-01

Instant enquiry acknowledgement

Any enquiry — Google Ads, Facebook, web form, widget, missed call — gets a WhatsApp and email acknowledgement within 60 seconds, naming the enquiry, the date asked about, and who will call.

lib/lead-capture.ts (deferred tail already exists)

● INERT

WAVE 1

C-02

Missed-call rescue

An unanswered inbound call triggers an immediate "sorry we missed you" WhatsApp with a callback slot picker, and creates a lead if none exists.

MissedCallRescue · Runo telephony is live

● INERT

WAVE 1

C-03

Conversational qualification bot

WhatsApp bot collects date, guest count, budget band and function type before a human ever engages, and writes them onto the lead.

New — inbound WhatsApp parsing partly built

● BUILD

WAVE 3

C-04

Self-serve date availability and hold

Customer checks a date and places a temporary hold without a salesperson. Public configurator and hold flow are live.

/configure · /hold · PublicHold

● FIRING

LIVE

C-05

Hold expiry ladder

Reminders before a held date lapses, then a clean release with a last-chance offer. Expiry runs; the warning messages do not reach anyone.

cron/hold-expiry · public-hold-expiry

● INERT

WAVE 1

C-06

Quote delivery with read receipts

Quotation goes out as a trackable link; opens, time-on-page and tier comparisons are recorded and shown to the rep.

QuoteShareLink · QuoteView · /q

● INERT

WAVE 1

C-07

Viewed-but-unpaid quote nudge

A quote opened but not acted on for 24 hours triggers one nudge, fired once only.

cron/quote-nudge (frequent lane — daily today)

● INERT

WAVE 1

C-08

Abandoned-configurator recovery

A public quote draft left incomplete is marked abandoned and enters a recovery sequence.

cron/configurator-abandonment · winback-abandoned-quote

● INERT

WAVE 2

C-09	Online payment and receipt Razorpay-hosted payment link with signed webhook confirmation and automatic ledger posting. Working today. /pay · api/payments/webhook	● FIRING LIVE
C-10	Installment reminder ladder The 30/50/20 payment schedule reminds at T-7, T-3, T-1 and on overdue, each with a one-tap payment link, escalating to the owner after a set overdue period. cron/payment-reminders · invoice-due	● INERT WAVE 1
C-11	Booking confirmation pack On confirmation, automatically issue the contract for e-signature, raise the advance invoice, send the welcome pack, and invite the couple into the host portal. booking.actions · esign · portal-invite	● INERT WAVE 2
C-12	Contract e-signature round trip Send, chase and countersign without manual steps. The internal signature flow exists; no external e-sign provider is connected. ESignRequest · ESIGN_PROVIDER unset	● BUILD WAVE 2
C-13	Planning milestone nudges Menu selection, guest list, seating and vendor choices each get a deadline and a reminder chain into the host portal. Task templates · portal	● INERT WAVE 2
C-14	Guest RSVP and reminders Hosts invite their own guests; the system chases RSVPs and sends event-week reminders with directions. GuestInvitation · GuestReminder · /rsvp	● INERT WAVE 2
C-15	Pre-event confirmation ladder At 48, 24, 12 and 4 hours out: confirm headcount with the host, confirm arrival with each vendor, and run a readiness check one hour before. cron/event-interval-reminders	● INERT WAVE 1
C-16	Event-day live channel A day-of WhatsApp thread for the host with the run sheet, the on-site coordinator's number, and timeline updates as phases complete. New — run-of-show data exists	● BUILD WAVE 3
C-17	Post-event feedback then review request Feedback survey the morning after; a Google review request only to those who rate well; a service-recovery task raised for those who do not. cron/review-requests · public-feedback	● INERT WAVE 2
C-18	Referral code issuance Five-star reviewers automatically receive a personal referral code with a reward schedule; payouts accrue on conversion. cron/referral-flywheel · referral-payouts · /refer	● INERT WAVE 2

C-19	Win-back campaigns Three separate re-engagement paths — lost leads, abandoned quotes, and approaching-anniversary proximity. cron/winback-lost-lead · winback-event-proximity	● INERT WAVE 2
C-20	Vendor confirm and decline loop Assigned vendors receive a link to confirm or decline; non-responders are chased; declines raise a replacement task automatically. cron/vendor-reminders · /vendor-confirm	● INERT WAVE 1

08 Team end — work that should never need a human to remember it

T-01	Automatic lead allocation Round-robin across the active sales team, weighted by open load and availability, with source and value overrides. The engine exists; no rules are configured , so allocation is manual today. <code>AssignmentRule · lib/routing · rep-availability</code>	● INERT WAVE 1
T-02	Speed-to-lead SLA ladder An unanswered new lead escalates to the head after a defined window, then to management. This is the highest-value automation in the system and it currently evaluates once a day. <code>cron/fast · lib/sla/war-room-escalation</code>	● INERT WAVE 1
T-03	Automatic cadence enrolment New leads enter a follow-up sequence based on source, score and event date; replying exits them automatically so nobody gets double-chased. <code>Cadence · autoEnrollCriteria · cadence-executor</code>	● INERT WAVE 1
T-04	Engagement roll-up Every note, call, message and status change rolls into a per-lead touch count, last-contacted and last-modified. Recently built and running. <code>lib/crm/engagement.ts</code>	● FIRING LIVE
T-05	Call logging without manual entry Telephony call records sync automatically and count as engagement. Blocked by the orphaned job in B5. <code>cron/sync-runo — not in any lane</code>	● INERT WAVE 0
T-06	Stage-gated task generation Moving a lead or deal to a new stage creates that stage's task set and blocks advancement when preconditions are unmet. <code>lib/blueprint-engine.ts</code>	● INERT WAVE 2
T-07	Discount and cancellation approvals A quote past a discount threshold, or any invoice cancellation, routes to an approver chain instead of relying on convention. <code>ApprovalRule · approval-engine</code>	● INERT WAVE 2
T-08	Event operations provisioning Confirming a booking builds the whole operational plan from SOP templates — phases, tasks, checklists, staffing slots — with a nightly reconcile job re-provisioning anything that failed. <code>lib/ops · cron/reconcile-ops</code>	● FIRING LIVE
T-09	Function sheet, kitchen plan and requisition generation Menu selections and headcount should generate the BEO, the kitchen production plan and the purchase requisition without re-keying. The modules exist; the automatic chain between them does not. <code>beo · kitchen · procurement</code>	● BUILD WAVE 2

T-10	Sales-to-operations handover SLA A confirmed booking not handed to operations within 24 hours nags the owner, then escalates. cron/handover-sla	● INERT WAVE 1
T-11	Readiness watchdog Near-term events with unassigned tasks, unconfirmed vendors or open procurement escalate to the operations head before they become event-day problems. cron/readiness-watchdog	● INERT WAVE 1
T-12	Morning briefing per person Each team member receives their tasks for today's events before the day starts. cron/event-briefings	● INERT WAVE 1
T-13	Event lifecycle transitions Bookings move to in-progress on the day and auto-complete afterwards when clean; unclean ones are flagged rather than silently closed. cron/event-lifecycle	● FIRING LIVE
T-14	Ledger posting and self-healing Invoices and payments post to the general ledger automatically, and a nightly job re-posts anything that failed to. cron/gl-reconcile	● FIRING LIVE
T-15	Vendor bill three-way match Match the bill against the assignment and the agreed line before it can be approved for payment, flagging variances instead of paying them. vendor-bill.actions – rules partly present	● BUILD WAVE 2
T-16	Bank reconciliation auto-matching Rule-based matching of bank transactions to invoices and payouts, leaving only genuine exceptions for a human. FinReconRule · FinBankTxn	● BUILD WAVE 3
T-17	Attendance to payroll pipeline Attendance and leave feed the monthly sheet, which feeds payroll inputs, which produce payslips — with an approval gate, not automatic disbursement. hr-attendance-sheet · hr-payroll-run	● BUILD WAVE 3
T-18	Payslip distribution Approved payslips are delivered to each employee automatically rather than shared by hand. HrPayslipDocument · blocked by B1 and B3	● INERT WAVE 2
T-19	HR lifecycle reminders Birthdays, work anniversaries, probation ends, contract ends and document expiry, each with a day-count offset and a per-day idempotency guard. HrReminderRule · cron/hr-reminders	● INERT WAVE 1

T-20	Onboarding and exit journeys A new hire's account, asset issue, document collection and training tasks generate from a template on the offer being accepted; exits reverse it. OnboardingTemplate · EmployeeJourney	● BUILD WAVE 3
T-21	Reimbursement round trip Claims with attachments route to HR, can be sent back for missing information, and resubmit without a new claim. Built last week; approval notices depend on B1. hr-reimbursement.actions	● INERT WAVE 1
T-22	Data hygiene sweeps Duplicate detection on contacts and vendors, enquiry-source backfill, phone normalisation and trash purging all run nightly. cron/enquiry-source-backfill · trash-purge · lib/dedup	● FIRING LIVE
T-23	Points, quests and slump detection Actions award points idempotently; leaderboards and quests refresh; a sweep catches reps whose activity has dropped. lib/velos · cron/velos-slump	● FIRING LIVE

09 Management end — visibility and control without asking anyone

M-01	Daily leadership digest One message each morning: enquiries yesterday by source, response times against SLA, quotes out, collections received, today's events and anything at risk. The per-person briefing exists; the leadership roll-up does not. <code>Extend cron/event-briefings</code>	● BUILD WAVE 1
M-02	Weekly business review pack Funnel conversion by stage and by rep, revenue booked versus collected, occupancy by venue, cost per lead and per booking by channel — generated and delivered, not assembled by hand. <code>analytics · sales-reports · marketing-report</code>	● BUILD WAVE 2
M-03	Anomaly alerts Unusual discounts, payment mismatches, cancellation spikes and margin outliers surface as alerts rather than waiting to be noticed. <code>cron/anomaly-detection · AnomalyAlert · FinAnomaly</code>	● INERT WAVE 2
M-04	SLA exception war room A single live view of every breach across sales, support, operations and BD, with tiered escalation already defined. <code>lib/sla · sla-warroom.actions</code>	● INERT WAVE 1
M-05	Attribution roll-up Booked revenue is attributed back to campaign and channel nightly, with customer lifetime value refreshed first so the numbers agree. <code>cron/attribution-rollup · customer-360</code>	● FIRING LIVE
M-06	Offline conversion upload to Google Ads Qualified leads and actual bookings are pushed back to Google Ads so the bidding algorithm optimises for revenue rather than form fills. The API and expiry handling are built; the loop is not closed. <code>api/v1/marketing/offline-conversions</code>	● INERT WAVE 2
M-07	Channel spend reallocation A nightly recommendation on shifting budget between channels, computed from cost per acquisition, return on ad spend and lifetime value. <code>cron/channel-reallocation</code>	● INERT WAVE 3
M-08	Demand-based pricing refresh Occupancy and demand signals per venue and date recompute nightly, driving premiums on peak and auspicious dates and sell-down targets on soft ones. <code>cron/yield-demand-refresh · sell-down-refresh</code>	● FIRING LIVE
M-09	Cash flow and collection forecast Projected collections from the installment schedule against committed vendor and payroll outflow, with a shortfall alert. <code>finance-cashflow.actions</code>	● BUILD WAVE 3

M-10	Statutory compliance calendar PF, ESI, professional tax, TDS and GST filing dates with advance reminders and a record of what was filed. The calculations exist; the calendar does not. hr-statutory · finance-tax	● BUILD WAVE 3
M-11	Performance scorecards Monthly KRA scorecards scored from automatic metrics with gates, bands and multipliers, plus the incentive calculation that follows. lib/kra · cron/performance-scores	● FIRING LIVE
M-12	Franchise revenue share Monthly accrual of partner revenue share and referral payouts, computed rather than reconciled by hand. cron/franchise-revshare · referral-payouts	● INERT WAVE 3
M-13	System health alerting to a real channel Cron failures and integration outages currently raise in-app admin notifications, which nobody watches. These should reach a phone. The heartbeat and health endpoint already exist to build on. lib/cron/run-lane.ts · /api/health	● BUILD WAVE 0
M-14	Quality and Six Sigma reporting Defects per million opportunities, Pareto analysis and control charts over real operational data, delivered monthly instead of pulled. quality module exists · delivery does not	● BUILD WAVE 3
M-15	Board and investor pack A generated monthly pack — profit and loss, occupancy, pipeline coverage, cohort retention — from the ledger rather than a spreadsheet. api/finance/investor-pack (skeleton)	● BUILD WAVE 3

10 Suggested sequencing

Ordered so that the cheapest, highest-leverage work happens first. Wave 0 is mostly configuration and would visibly change the business within a week.

WAVE 0 · WEEK 1 · CONFIGURATION, NOT CODE

Switch on what already exists

Nothing here requires new features. It converts a large amount of dormant work into working automation.

- Add the email and SMS credentials to production (B1)
- Set real cron cadences, or attach an external scheduler (B2)
- Register the orphaned telephony sync job (B5)
- Route system-health alerts to a channel someone reads (M-13)
- Connect the repository to deployments and add continuous integration (B4)

WAVE 1 · WEEKS 2–5 · THE REVENUE LOOP

Never lose a lead, never miss a payment

Configure the rules the engines are waiting for, and verify each one end to end with a real record.

- Lead allocation rules and the speed-to-lead escalation ladder (T-01, T-02)
- Cadence definitions with auto-enrolment by source and score (T-03)
- Instant acknowledgement and missed-call rescue (C-01, C-02)
- Quote nudges, payment reminder ladder, hold expiry warnings (C-05, C-07, C-10)
- Pre-event reminder ladder and vendor confirmations (C-15, C-20)
- Handover SLA, readiness watchdog, morning briefings (T-10, T-11, T-12)
- Daily leadership digest (M-01)

WAVE 2 · WEEKS 6–12 · DELIVERY AND THE BACK OFFICE

Close the loops around the event itself

- Object storage, then the document-dependent automations (B3, T-18)
- Booking confirmation pack and e-signature round trip (C-11, C-12)
- Function sheet, kitchen plan and requisition chain (T-09)
- Approval chains on discount and cancellation (T-07)
- Post-event feedback, reviews, referrals, win-back (C-17, C-18, C-19)
- Offline conversion upload closing the Google Ads loop (M-06)
- Weekly business review pack and anomaly alerting (M-02, M-03)

WAVE 3 · QUARTER 2 · INTELLIGENCE

Work the system does that nobody asked it to

- The API layer, if external orchestration is the chosen direction (section 04)
- Conversational qualification and the event-day channel (C-03, C-16)
- Bank reconciliation matching and the payroll pipeline (T-16, T-17)
- Onboarding and exit journeys (T-20)
- Cash flow forecasting, compliance calendar, board pack (M-09, M-10, M-15)
- Channel spend reallocation acting on its own recommendations (M-07)

11 Traps this codebase has already caught people with

Hand this list to whoever is hired on their first day. Every item below has cost real time already.

- **Graceful degradation hides everything.** Missing credentials return an error object that nobody checks, rather than throwing. Assume an integration is dead until the health page says otherwise.
- **Dates are stored as UTC midnight.** Filtering a month with a local-time window silently drops records at the edges. This has produced wrong counts on the calendar more than once.
- **Files marked "use server" may only export async functions.** Exporting a constant builds fine locally and fails on the host.

- **Schema changes against production must be additive.** Never accept data loss to push a migration; adding a unique constraint to an existing populated table will fail.
- **Uploads die at roughly 4.5 MB** because there is no object storage and files travel as base64 through a server action.
- **Every scheduled award or message needs an idempotency key.** The points engine already does this; anything new must, because lanes can and do re-run.
- **Build-time type checking is disabled.** Type-check changed files directly before shipping, because the deploy will not.
- **Two permission systems coexist** — a global one and a separate one for the BD pipeline. Check both before assuming a user can see something.
- **Unknown permission keys return false.** A typo in a permission name produces a silently dead button for everybody, not an error.

12 What we are asking the automation specialist to own

The role is less "build new automation" than "make an ambitious system that already exists actually run, then extend it deliberately."

AREA	WHAT OWNERSHIP MEANS
Reliability	Every scheduled job runs on its intended cadence, records a heartbeat, and alerts a human when it fails. Today nobody can answer "did the reminders go out last night?" without reading a database.
Deliverability	Own the messaging stack end to end — provider credentials, WhatsApp template approval, sender reputation, opt-outs, and the 24-hour WhatsApp session window that governs when a template is mandatory.
Rule configuration	The assignment, cadence, approval, escalation and scoring engines are all configuration-driven and all essentially empty. Populating them well is a business-judgement job, not just an engineering one.
Integration surface	Decide and then build the external interface: either a versioned API with key auth, or an in-process orchestration layer. Do not leave it ambiguous.
Verification	Each automation ships with a way to prove it fired — a log, a counter, a test record run through the whole path. "It should work" is how the current situation happened.

Skills that actually matter here: TypeScript and Node, Next.js server actions, Prisma and Postgres, webhook and queue design with idempotency, and hands-on experience with WhatsApp Business templates, transactional email deliverability and Indian telephony providers. Workflow-tool experience alone — n8n, Zapier, Make — is not sufficient, because as of today there is very little for those tools to call.

First week, concretely: read section 06, fix B1 and B2, watch the integration health page turn green, then run one real lead through capture to acknowledgement to allocation to reminder and confirm every step left a trace. That single trace will teach more about this system than any walkthrough.

Prepared from a direct survey of the codebase and the production environment on 7 September 2026 — module inventory, scheduled-job registration, and the deployed environment variable set. Figures are counted, not estimated. The status of each register item reflects what is deployed today, and Wave 0 changes most of it.